711-04-DRMD

Department of Social Welfare and Development

BAGONG PILIPINAS

DISASTER RESPONSE MANAGEMENT DIVISION

FIELD OFFICE CARAGA

DSWD-GF-008 | REV 04 | 04 FEB 2025

ROUTING AND TRACKING SLIP

SUBJECT: EXECUTIVE SUMMARY RE RDRMC 2025	**DRN:** CARAGA-FO-DRMD-DRRMS-A-REP-25-09-27568-S
DATE CREATED: Wed, September 03, 2025 03:40 PM	**DEADLINE:**

FROM			NOTES/REMARKS	TO		
NAME/ OFFICE	**DATE**	**TIME**		**NAME/ OFFICE**	**DATE**	**TIME**
CARAGA-FO-DRMD-DRRMS	01/09/2025	04:42 PM				
DRMD	9/4		FS	DRMD	9/9	10:00am
DRMD	9/11	11:00	FS	DRMD	9/9	
ARDA	09	SEP 2025	Forwarded to DRMD	DRMD	9/11	2:57 PM

KNOWLEDGE SHARING SESSION (BIG GROUP) DOCUMENTATION REPORT

1. **Organizing FO**	DSWD FO Caraga
2. **Event name**	**REGIONAL DISASTER RESPONSE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCE (RDRMC) 2025: EMPOWERING COMMUNITIES AND BUILDING CLIMATE RESILIENCE THROUGH PROJECT LAWA AT BINHI**
3. **Date of event**	**August 27-29, 2025**
4. **Venue of event**	Watergate Hotel, Butuan City and Buenavista, Agusan del Norte
5. **Documenter**	Rutchel R. Molino, PDO III/MER Focal
6. **Links**	
• *Event Program*	https://tinyurl.com/5btyhuf8
• *Presentation materials*	https://tinyurl.com/5btyhuf8

7. a. **Resource Person**
- Name: Mari-Flor A. Dollaga-Libang
- Job title: Regional Director
- Organization: DSWD FO Caraga
- Contact details:
  - *Mobile:*
  - *E-mail:*
  - *Personal website:*

8. a. **Resource Person**
- Name: Tristan C. Telen
- Job title: Assistant Regional Director for Administration
- Organization: DSWD FO Caraga
- Contact details:
  - *Mobile:*
  - *E-mail:*
  - *Personal website:*

9. a. **Resource Person**
- Name: Jean Paul S. Parajes
- Job title: Assistant Regional Director for Operations
- Organization: DSWD FO Caraga
- Contact details:
  - *Mobile:*
  - *E-mail:*
  - *Personal website:*

10. a. **Resource Person**
- Name: Aldie Mae A. Andoy
- Job title: OIC Chief, DRMD
- Organization: DSWD FO Caraga
- Contact details:
  - *Mobile:*
  - *E-mail:*
  - *Personal website:*

11. a. **Resource Person**

- Name: Alicia T. Marquiso
- Job title: DRRS Head
- Organization: DSWD FO Caraga
- Contact details:
  - *Mobile:*
  - *E-mail:*
  - *Personal website:*

12. a. **Resource Person**

- Name: Rutchel R. Molino
- Job title: Project Development Officer III/MER Focal
- Organization: DSWD FO Caraga
- Contact details:
  - *Mobile:*
  - *E-mail:*
  - *Personal website:*

a. **Resource Person**

- Name: Jazzner Julian S. De Dios
- Job title: Project Development Officer III/Luzon Island Cluster Focal
- Organization: Disaster Response Management Bureau, DSWD Central Office
- Contact details:
  - *Mobile:*
  - *E-mail:*
  - *Personal website:*

a. **Resource Person**

- Name: Maria Isabel B. Lanada, PhD
- Job title: Director IV
- Organization: Disaster Response Management Bureau, DSWD Central Office
- Contact details:
  - *Mobile:*
  - *E-mail:*
  - *Personal website:*

13. Participants

Section	Number of Participants	No. of Male	No. of Female
DSWD FO Caraga Staff	35	17	18
DRMB, DSWD CO Staff	2	1	1
Partner NGAs Staff	8	3	5
Provincial and Municipal Local Government Unit Personnel	106	27	79
TOTAL	**151**	**48**	**103**

14. Please provide a brief description of your activity. *(To indicate rationale, objectives, expected outputs, Organizational Outcome/Strategic Initiative met by the KSS).*

The Regional Disaster Response Management Conference (RDRMC) 2025 is an annual event organized by the Disaster Response Management Division (DRMD) of DSWD Field Office Caraga in observance of National Disaster Resilience Month, as mandated by Executive Order No. 29, s. 2017. Scheduled on August 27–29, 2025 in Butuan City, this year's RDRMC features "Empowering Communities and Building Climate Resilience through Project LAWA at BINHI," bringing together key disaster response actors to assess regional progress, strengthen coordination, and promote inclusive, climate-smart interventions.

The conference and field visit highlighted the implementation of Project LAWA at BINHI, DSWD's flagship program addressing water scarcity and food insecurity, successfully rolled out in 26 LGUs and 84 barangays, benefiting over 7,000 individuals and served as a venue for a Program Implementation Review (PIR), sharing of best practices, and recognition of outstanding LGU partners, reinforcing DSWD Caraga's commitment to building disaster-resilient communities through collaborative and community-driven efforts.

15. Objectives

General Objective:

To conduct a comprehensive, participatory, and evidence-based implementation review of **Project LAWA at BINHI** under the **Risk Resiliency Program – Cash-for-Training and Work (RRP-CFTW)**, with the goal of enhancing program impact, fostering shared learning, and reinforcing climate and disaster resilience at the community level.

Specific Objectives:

1. To present and validate accomplishments, key milestones, innovations, and implementation challenges of Project LAWA at BINHI across all participating LGUs and barangays in Caraga Region;
2. To gather constructive feedback, reflections, and insights from Local Government Units (LGUs), provincial technical working groups, and community-based implementers to inform program improvements;
3. To identify and document lessons learned, promising practices, and community-driven strategies for possible scaling and replication in future resilience programs;
4. To facilitate inter-agency dialogue and strengthen coordination mechanisms among DSWD, LGUs, and other stakeholders in support of a harmonized approach to disaster response and risk reduction;
5. To formally recognize and showcase the contributions of outstanding LGUs in successfully implementing Project LAWA at BINHI and advancing the goals of climate resilience and food-water security.

16. Proceedings

Day 1 – August 27, 2025 (Wednesday)

Opening activities commenced at 8:00 a.m. with registration, preliminaries, and the presentation of the 4Ps (Purpose, Product, Process, and People), to align participants' expectations. Sessions covered project accomplishments, analytics, updated guidelines, and workshops on implementation reflection, thematic challenges, good practices documentation, and action planning for CY 2026. Key resource speakers included Ms. Aldie Mae A. Andoy, OIC-Division Chief; Ms. Alicia T. Marquiso, DRRS Head and concurrent RRP Focal; and Ms. Rutchel R. Molino, RRP MER Focal. The event was attended by

representatives from the Provincial and Municipal Technical Working Groups, as well as national agencies such as the Department of Environment and Natural Resources (DENR), the Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources (BFAR), and the Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE).

Regional Director, Mari-Flor A. Dollaga delivered an inspiring message emphasizing the project's vital role in supporting affected communities and its long-term impact in enhancing adaptive capacities and empowering local populations. She emphasized the importance of collaboration, alignment of goals, and collective effort to ensure the project's success and sustainability.

Discussions highlighted key challenges during implementation, including gaps in documentation and coordination, limited resource allocation, and inadequate market linkages for locally produced goods. Recommendations to address these include establishing a robust documentation system, improving communication channels among TWG members, integrating clear funding provisions in the Annual Investment Program (AIP), and exploring alternative financing models such as public-private partnerships, community-driven initiatives, and local fundraising. Capacity-building efforts should also be strengthened to optimize available resources.
Furthermore, the TWG members recommended enhancing market access through initiatives such as harvest festivals, Food-for-Training activities, and value-adding programs. In addition, a comprehensive policy framework should be developed to clearly define agency roles, secure dedicated resource support, and ensure the long-term sustainability of Project LAWA at BINHI.

Day 2 – August 28, 2025 (Thursday)

Morning sessions featured the presentation of Project LAWA at BINHI guidelines and an open forum with DRMB and DSWD Field Office Caraga officials and personnel. Key speakers included Director Maria Isabel B. Lanada from the Disaster Response Management Bureau (DRMB) and Mr. Jazzner Julian S. De Dios, Luzon Island Cluster Focal Person, representing Ms. Abbey Margarette Despabiladeras, Mindanao Island Cluster Focal Person.

Discussions focused on the 2026 budget allocation and the importance of LGU counterpart funding to support the program. Since budget planning is still ongoing at the Central Office level, Director Lanada encouraged LGUs to ensure counterpart funding is integrated into their Annual Investment Program (AIP), regardless of any increase or decrease in budget allocation. She assured participants that the same areas would remain covered for 2026, with a three-year assistance plan subject to assessment by the Provincial TWG. The morning session concluded with an action planning workshop that emphasized collaboration, effective planning, and strategic actions to ensure the project's long-term success and sustainability.

The afternoon session highlighted the Klimalasakit Awards and Recognition Ceremony, where partner implementers were recognized for their unwavering dedication, exemplary service, proactive partnership, and instrumental contributions to the success of RRP-CFTW Project LAWA at BINHI. Special awards were presented to:

- The fastest LGU in project implementation and completion
- The top-ranking LGU for overall project performance
- LGUs with a 100% fund utilization rate
- LGUs recognized for timely submission of engagement documents and completion of program activities
- LGUs that provided counterpart funding

- NGAs acknowledged for their technical expertise, strategic guidance, and steadfast support

The ceremony also featured talent showcases from Provincial and Municipal TWG members and inspirational messages from partner agencies and provincial governors. The event was graced by Mr. Jean Paul S. Parajes, ARDO, and Mr. Tristan C. Telen, ARDA, along with Local Chief Executives from the municipal LGUs.

The day concluded with a Pledge of Commitment and the presentation of plaques and certificates, underscoring the dedication of LGUs and partner agencies to sustaining disaster response programs.

Day 3 – August 29, 2025 (Friday)

The RRP-CFTW Team of DSWD Field Office Caraga, led by Ms. Marquiso, RRP Program Focal, together with Mr. De Dios from the RRP-CFTW Central Office and partner agencies from DENR and DOLE Caraga, conducted a site visit to Buenavista, Agusan del Norte. The visit included a courtesy call to provincial officials of Agusan del Norte, municipal officials of Buenavista, and barangay officials of Malpoc. It showcased Project LAWA at BINHI implementation sites, highlighting the project's contribution to community resilience and sustainable resource management.

A short program was held where local officials and leaders of farmers' associations expressed their gratitude for the program's positive impact on their communities. The team then conducted an ocular inspection and a focused group discussion with partner beneficiaries. Mr. De Dios provided technical assistance, centering discussions on the operation, maintenance, and sustainability of the projects to ensure long-term community benefits. Key discussion points included:

- Vermicomposting using banana peels as feed for African Night Crawlers (ANC), noting that earthworms can grow twice their normal size and produce nutrient-rich organic matter.
- Strengthening partnerships with existing cooperatives for faster and more sustainable implementation compared to individual efforts.
- Expanding cassava production and linking outputs from BINHI sites to established cooperatives to enhance market access and economic sustainability.
- Scaling up training and capability-building programs to support continuous improvement.

This visit marked a significant milestone in the collaboration between national and local authorities to promote sustainable development and improve the livelihoods of the residents of Barangay Malpoc.

17. Issues and Concerns/Action Points and Deliverables/Summary of Agreements

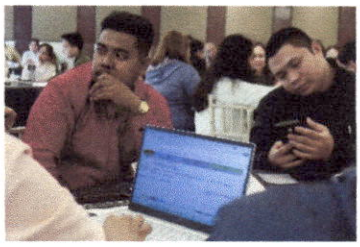
This summary captured the key insights and decisions made by the participants, addressing various concerns and outlining the collective strategies, marking a crucial step towards refining the project's implementation and ensuring its future success.

Areas of Concern	Agreements/ Recommendations	Responsible Person
Soon to Expire (SOTEX) Family Food Packs	• Use of SOTEX Family Food Packs for the Maintenance of Project LAWA at BINHI.	• LGU / DRMD, DSWD FO Caraga

Target Areas for CY 2026	• Target areas will remain the same as those identified in 2025 and may be extended for up to three (3) years, subject to the assessment and recommendation of the Technical Working Groups (TWGs).	• Provincial and Municipal LGU
Budget Allocation for CY 2026	• Ongoing CO budget planning. The TWG shall ensure that the program's fund counterpart is incorporated into their Annual Investment Plan (AIP), regardless of any increase or decrease in the approved allocation.	• Provincial and Municipal LGU
DOLE Budget for implementation of Project LAWA at BINHI for CY 2025 and onwards.	• No budget allocated yet for CY 2025. However, DOLE TUPAD coordinators will lobby for inclusion in their respective budget proposals.	• DOLE Caraga
Additional support for the operation, maintenance, and sustainability of Project LAWA at BINHI, including the formation and strengthening of organizations, and the enhancement of existing market linkages.	• Lobby for additional support from partner agencies and programs, prioritizing organizational development and improved market linkage initiatives.	• LGU / DRMD, DSWD FO Caraga
Passage of TWG Executive Orders, Ordinances, and Resolutions to ensure the operation, maintenance, and sustainability of Project LAWA at BINHI.	• Full completion and issuance of all required orders, ordinances, and resolutions to support project implementation.	• LGU / DRMD, DSWD FO Caraga
LGU Ordinance requiring all households to plant "pinakbet" vegetables for food security and environmental sustainability.	• LGU Libjo to provide a copy of the ordinance to DSWD FO Caraga for potential replication by other LGUs.	• LGU Libjo, Province of Dinagat Islands
Securing ECC / CNC and Other Permits for Implementation of Small Farm Reservoir / Fishpond	• Central Office representative to clarify this matter with DRMB, as DSWD has already signed an MOU with the concerned agencies at the national level. • DSWD FO Caraga to coordinate with BFAR and DENR for legal and regulatory requirements related to the project.	• DRMB, DSWD Central Office • DRMD, DSWD FO Caraga

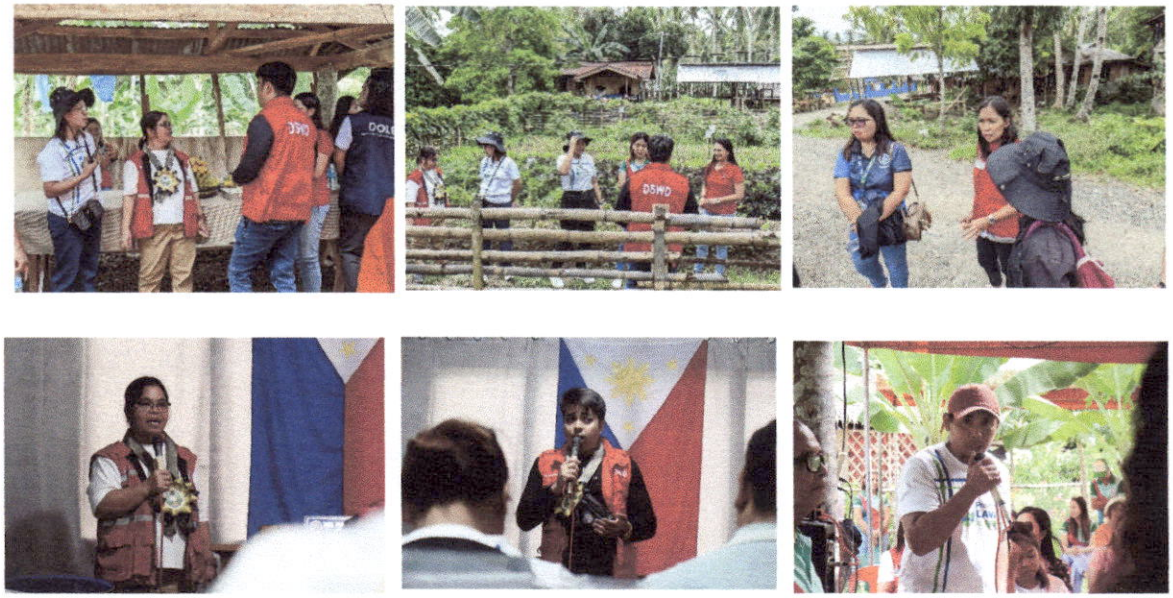
16. Photo Documentation

Day 1 – August 27, 2025



Day 2 – August 28, 2025

Day 3 – August 29, 2025



Prepared by:

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PDO III/ RRP MER Focal

Approved by:

ALDIE MAE A. ANDOY
OIC-Chief, DRMD

Noted by:

MARI-FLOR A. DOLLAGA-LIBANG
Regional Director

For the Regional Director:

TRISTAN C. TELEN, PhD. MA, REB
Director III / ARDA